



1791

DREAM OF THE RED CHAMBER

One of China's four great classical novels, *Dream of the Red Chamber* was written by Cao Xuequin and published in 1791. A semi-autobiographical novel featuring hundreds of characters, it provides rich insight into Qing dynasty society in its story about the wealthy Jia family.

◀ Scene from *Dream of the Red Chamber*, a Chinese classic

1790

1791 The Haitian Revolution

sees enslaved people overthrow the system of slavery and form the first Black Republic in the Americas

1792 Mary Wollstonecraft

publishes *A Vindication of the Rights of Woman*, an early feminist text

1792 Denmark abolishes

the slave trade, becoming the first country in the world to do so

“I do not wish them [women] to have power over men; but over themselves.”

MARY WOLLSTONECRAFT, *A VINDICATION OF THE RIGHTS OF WOMAN*, 1792

1792

WAR OF THE FIRST COALITION

From 1792 to 1802, France was embroiled in a series of wars with Britain, the Holy Roman Empire, Prussia, and Russia, all keen to stop the revolution from spreading. The

War of the First Coalition (1792-97) began with a short-lived Austro-Prussian invasion of France that was turned back at the Battle of Valmy in September 1792.

After a series of defeats, the French secured major victories from 1794, including against the Austrians at Fleurus (1794). The Austrians sued for peace after the French general Napoleon Bonaparte decimated their forces in Italy (1796-97).



△ Battle of Valmy, 20 September 1792